

2 Printing, Sealing and Transportation of Question Papers

- Once finalised, the question papers are meant to be printed under strict vigil at secure facilities to minimise the risk of leaks
- The papers are sealed in tamper-evident envelopes or containers, equipped with multiple layers of security, including barcodes. These are to be stored in secure locations, often under CCTV surveillance and guarded by security personnel
- The sealed question papers are transported in trunks to examination centres with armed escorts. GPS tracking systems are used to monitor the transportation process

THE PROBLEM

A day before the exam, an accused in an earlier paper leak scam from Bihar claimed that papers would be leaked from the private printing press engaged by the NTA. The Bihar police probe has indicated the involvement of insiders in the suspected leak; nearly two dozen people have been arrested so far in Bihar, Gujarat and Maharashtra too. The CBI is now probing the irregularities

3 Examination Centres

- On the day of the examination, the sealed question papers are to be opened in the presence of designated officials and students. A detailed log is maintained
- All examination centres are under CCTV cameras, with live feeds going to the NTA's Central Control Room in Delhi for monitoring
- The answer sheets are sent to NTA headquarters by the local post office in sealed trunks



THE PROBLEM

- Of the 399 exam centres audited, 186 centres did not have the mandated two working CCTV cameras installed in each exam room
- At 68 exam centres, the strongroom, where question papers are kept, was not guarded
- At 83 centres, the biometric staff present was not the same as the designated staff for those centres



4 Evaluation of Answer Sheets

OMR (optical mark recognition) sheets are scanned using high-speed machines. The scanned data is then processed, and scores are calculated based on the answer keys. Results are compiled, verified and then published on the NTA website

THE PROBLEM

The NEET evaluation is done by an external agency. First, arbitrary grace marks were awarded—contrary to any established formula—to 1,563 students, which were later cancelled. An unprecedented 67 students got a perfect score of 720

Why the UGC-NET exam was postponed

The UGC-NET examination, a national-level test that determines eligibility for college and university-level assistant professorship and awards Junior Research Fellowships (JRF) to candidates, has been cancelled following a paper leak on the dark web

Candidates registered: Over 1 million



Why the CSIR exam was deferred

The CSIR-UGC-NET examination, which determines eligibility for lectureship and awards Junior Research Fellowships (JRF) in the fields of science and technology, has also been postponed as a precautionary measure

Candidates registered: 175,355